African flags lesson plan

Age 4 | 25 minutes | Whole group and individual work

Children explore the flags of Nigeria, Ghana, Botswana and Somalia through looking, talking and a supported circle-the-flag activity. Use the accompanying **African Flags Worksheet**.

Learning aims

By the end, children will have opportunities to:

- Match at least two spoken country names to their flags using the picture key and adult support.
- Point to or name a colour, stripe or star on a flag.
- Listen to one short instruction and respond by pointing or circling.

Country-name recall is emerging at this age; independent reading and memorising all four flags are not expected.

Prepare

- Print worksheet page 1 in colour for each child. Keep page 2 as the adult answer guide.
- Display a colour copy of the picture key. Cover the questions during the introduction.
- Provide thick pencils or crayons. Have a globe or map showing Africa ready, if available.

Teach the lesson

1 Welcome and notice | 3 minutes

Show the four flags. Ask: **“What colours can you see?”** Accept pointing, gestures and spoken answers. Explain: “A flag can help us recognise a country. These flags belong to four countries in Africa. Africa is a continent with many countries.” Point to Africa on your map, if using one.

2 Meet the four flags | 5 minutes

Point to each flag, say its country name clearly and invite children to repeat it. Use one visual clue for each:

- **Nigeria:** green, white, green stripes.
- **Ghana:** red, yellow and green, with a black star.
- **Botswana:** blue, with a black stripe edged in white.
- **Somalia:** blue, with a white star.

Ask: “Which two flags have stars?” Help children point to Ghana and Somalia.

African flags lesson sequence

Continue with the same four flags and the worksheet picture key.

3 Play point to the flag | 4 minutes

Say: “Point to Nigeria.” Wait, then point together and repeat the name. Try the other countries. Mix country prompts with clues: “Find the white star” or “Find the green, white and green stripes.” Invite everyone to stretch their arms into a star shape before sitting for the worksheet.

4 Complete the worksheet | 8 minutes

Model the first question: **“Find Nigeria. Let’s look at Nigeria in our picture key. Now look at these two flags. Which one matches?”** Demonstrate circling the whole flag. This first answer is guided practice.

Read questions 2 to 4 aloud, one at a time. Keep the key visible and give children time to compare. Ask, “What do you notice?” before offering a clue. Accept pointing if circling is difficult; an adult can record the choice. Praise careful looking and effort.

Answer key: 1 Nigeria - right; 2 Ghana - left; 3 Botswana - right; 4 Somalia - left.

5 Share and check | 5 minutes

Ask: “Which flag has a black star?” (Ghana.) “Point to a flag with blue.” (Botswana or Somalia.) Invite children to choose a favourite flag and describe one feature.

For a quick individual check, say two country names in a different order and ask each child to point to their flags in the key. Record whether the child matched them independently, with a clue, or after a model. Use this alongside worksheet observations; the modelled first answer does not show independent recognition.

Adapt to the child

More support: Begin with Nigeria and Somalia only. Say and point to each name, then offer the two flags. Repeat slowly, allow extra response time and accept home-language colour words or gestures.

More challenge: Ask the child to explain a choice using a stripe or star. If ready, briefly cover the key and ask for one familiar country, then uncover it to check together.

Next time

Repeat the pointing game in a new order. Revisit two flags if needed before introducing more countries. Optional follow-up: children draw their own flag and describe its colours; explain that it is their own design.